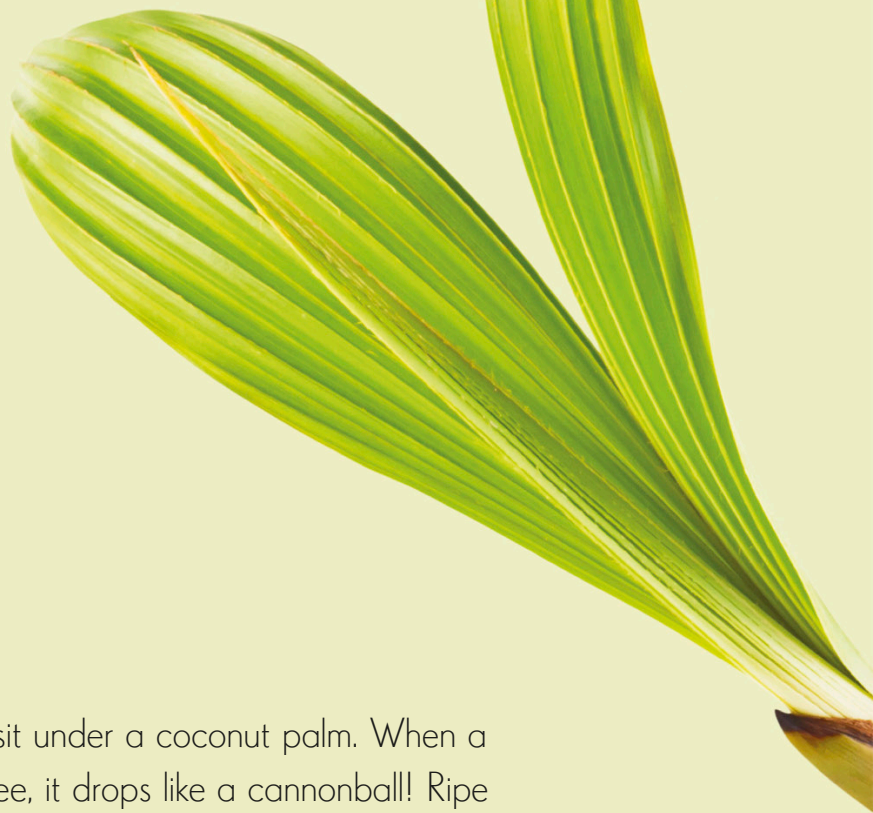


Palm



Whatever you do, don't sit under a coconut palm. When a coconut falls from a tree, it drops like a cannonball! Ripe coconuts have a thick, hairy jacket under their skin, which makes them float. If a coconut rolls down into the sea, it can bob about on the waves. When it washes up on a beach, it uses its store of food and "coconut milk" to grow into a new tree.

Gently curving palm trees magic up images of tropical, sunny beaches in our mind, but palms don't always have an easy life. When thunderstorms roll in, the trees are battered by wind and rain. Luckily, their fringed leaves let wind blow through and a bendy trunk stops the tree from snapping.